INCH-POUND

MIL-C-44380(GL)
2 November 1989
SUPERSEDING
MIL-P-44336(GL)
27 April 1988

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CLIMBERS' EQUIPMENT SET, SPECIAL OPERATIONS FORCES MOUNTAINEERING EQUIPMENT (SOFME)

This specification is approved for use by the Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Department of the Army, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers one complete Special Operations Forces Mountaineering Equipment (SOFME) Set.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 8465

AMSC N/A

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SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

A-A-203	-	Paper, Kraft, Untreated
A-A-50041	-	Snap Link, Mountain Piton, Locking and Nonlocking
A-A-50096	-	Hammer, Rock and Ice
A-A-50097	-	Pulley, Mountain, Rescue
A-A-50098	-	Stopper, Hexagon, Irregular
A-A-50106	-	Stopper, Wired, Wedged
A-A-50111	-	Piton, Mountain, Flat
A-A-50112	-	Piton, Mountain, Angle
A-A-50113	-	Piton, Ice
A-A-50114	-	Piton, Mountain, Knifeblade, Offset
A-A-50115	-	Piton, Mountain, Cliffhanger
A-A-50116	-	Axe, Ice
A-A-50117	-	Crampons, Hinged
A-A-50118	-	Straps, Crampon
A-A-50119	-	Anchor, Snow, Wired
A-A-50120	-	Harness, Climbing, Full-Body
A-A-50121	-	Protector, Crampon
A-A-50125	-	Descender, Figure-8
A-A-50127	-	Ascender, Cam Action
A-A-50139	-	Rope, Kernmantle
PPP-B-636	-	Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

MILITARY

MIL-R-1688	-	Rope, Nylon, Climbing Type
MIL-L-35078	-	Loads, Unit: Preparation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items; Clothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage; General Specification For
MIL-W-5625	-	Webbing, Textile, Nylon, Tubular

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-147	-	Palletized Unit Loads
MIL-STD-731	-	Quality of Wood Members for Containers and Pallets

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Naval Publications and Forms Center, (ATTN: NPODS), 5801 Tabor Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19120-5099.)

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DODISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS shall be the issues of the nongovernment documents which are current on the date of the solicitation.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103-1187.)

(Nongovernment standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations which prepare or which distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, the text of this specification shall take precedence. Nothing in this specification, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. One complete climbers' equipment set shall consist of the materials and quantities specified in table I. It is encouraged that recycled material be used when practical as long as it meets the requirements of this specification.

TABLE I. Container contents

Container	Quantity	Item description	Specification
Box 1	12 each	Harness, climbing	A-A-50120
	6 each	Stopper, wired, wedge, size I	A-A-50106
	6 each	Stopper, wired, wedge, size II	A-A-50106
	6 each	Stopper, wired, wedge, size III	A-A-50106
	6 each	Stopper, wired, wedge, size IV	A-A-50106
	6 each	Stopper, wired, wedge, size V	A-A-50106
	6 each	Stopper, wired, wedge, size VI	A-A-50106

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TABLE I. Container contents (cont'd)

Container	Quantity	Item description	Specification
Box 1 continued	6 each	Stopper, wired, wedge, size VII	A-A-50106
	6 each	Stopper, wired, wedge, size VIII	A-A-50106
	2 each	Rope, nylon, climbing type, 150 foot length	MIL-R-1688
Box 2	12 each	Axe, ice	A-A-50116
	6 each	Piton, mountain, flat, type I	A-A-50111
	6 each	Piton, mountain, flat, type II	A-A-50111
	6 each	Piton, mountain, flat, type III	A-A-50111
	8 each	Piton, mountain, flat, type IV	A-A-50111
	12 each	Piton, mountain, knife, blade, offset	A-A-50114
	6 each	Piton, mountain, angle, type I	A-A-50112
	6 each	Piton, mountain, angle, type II	A-A-50112
	6 each	Piton, mountain, angle, type III	A-A-50112
	4 each	Piton, mountain, cliffhanger	A-A-50115
	8 each	Piton, ice, type I	A-A-50113
	8 each	Piton, ice, type II	A-A-50113
Box 3	12 each	Hammer, rock and ice	A-A-50096
	12 pair	Crampons, hinged	A-A-50117
	14 pair	Straps, crampon	A-A-50118
	12 pair	Protectors, crampon	A-A-50121
Box 4	1 roll	Rope, kernmantle, type I, 150 feet long	A-A-50139
	1 roll	Rope, kernmantle, type II, 150 feet long	A-A-50139
	1 roll	Rope, kernmantle, type III, 150 feet long	A-A-50139
	12 each	Snap link, mountain, piton, type II	A-A-50041
	60 each	Snap link, mountain, piton, type III	A-A-50041

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TABLE I. Container contents (cont'd)

Container	Quantity	Item description	Specification
Box 4 continued	6 each	Stopper, hexagon, irregular, size I	A-A-50098
	6 each	Stopper, hexagon, irregular, size IIB	A-A-50098
Box 5	4 each	Rope, kernmantle, type IV, 165 feet long	A-A-50139
	8 each	Pulley, mountain rescue,	A-A-50097
	1 roll	Webbing, textile, nylon, tubular, 9/16 inch wide by 75 feet, long, color OD-7	MIL-W-5625
	1 roll	Webbing, textile, nylon, tubular, 1 inch wide by 75 feet, long, color OD-7	MIL-W-5625
	2 each	Anchor, snow, wired, size 1	A-A-50119
	2 each	Anchor, snow, wired, size 2	A-A-50119
Box 6	4 each	Rope, kernmantle, type IV, 165 feet long	A-A-50139
	8 pair	Ascenders, cam action	A-A-50127
	12 pair	Descender, figure-8	A-A-50125

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements (examinations and tests) as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to ensure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items shall meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of ensuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling inspection, as part of manufacturing operations, is an acceptable practice to ascertain conformance to requirements, however, this does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to accept defective material.

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4.2 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.2.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.2.2 Packaging examination. The fully packaged end items shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of shipping containers. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-2 (see 6.3).

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application
Materials	Any component missing, damaged, or not as specified
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as: incomplete sealing or closure of flap, improper taping, loose strapping or inadequate stapling Bulged or distorted container
Content	Number per container is more or less than required

4.2.3 Palletization examination. The fully packaged and palletized end items shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of palletized unit loads. The sample unit shall be one palletized unit load, fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-1 (see 6.3).

Examine	Defect
Finished dimensions	Length, width, or height exceeds specified maximum requirement
Palletization	Pallet pattern not as specified Interlocking of loads not as specified Load not bonded as specified
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limits
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application

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the serrations are sharp (no plastic fillings exist), and the serration depth

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Items shall be preserved as specified in the item documents.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or Commercial, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A packing. Items preserved as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in the quantities specified in table I in a fiberboard box conforming to style RSC-L, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The inside of each box shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, class weather-resistant, variety DW, grade V15c of PPP-B-636. Voids in the shipping container shall be filled with crumpled kraft paper conforming to A-A-203. Each box shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed in accordance with method V, and reinforced as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.2). Strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II, class F loads.

5.2.2 Level B packing. Items preserved as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in the quantities specified in table I in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC-L, type CF (variety SW) or SF, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a box liner conforming to type CF, variety DW, grade 200 of PPP-B-636. Voids in the shipping container shall be filled with crumpled kraft paper conforming to A-A-203.

5.2.2.1 Weather-resistant fiberboard containers. When specified (see 6.2), the shipping container shall be a grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636, and closed in accordance with method III, as specified in the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.3 Commercial packing. Items preserved as specified in 3.2 shall be packed in accordance with ASTM D-3951.

5.3 Palletization. When specified (see 6.2), items packed as specified in 5.2. 2 or 5.2.3, shall be palletized on a 4-way entry pallet in accordance with load type Ia of MIL-STD-147. Pallet type shall be type I (4-way entry), type IV, or type V in accordance with MIL-STD-147. Pallets shall be fabricated from wood groups I, II, III, or IV of MIL-STD-731. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means C and D, or film bonding means F or G.

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5.4 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, shipping containers and palletized unit loads shall be marked in acccrdance with MIL-STD-129 or ASTM D-3951, as applicable.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. The climbers' equipment set is intended to provide climbing aids for rock, snow, and ice terrain for up to 12 personnel of the Special Operations Forces.

6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1.1 and 2.2).
c. Levels of preservation and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
d. Type and class of unit load (see 5.2.1).
e. When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.2.2.1).
f. When palletization is required (see 5.3).
g. Acceptance criteria required (see 6.3).

6.3 Acceptance criteria. The acceptance criteria below are recommended for use. The acceptance criteria as specified in the contract or purchase order shall be binding. Unless otherwise specified, the following acceptance criteria are in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

6.3.1 For packaging examination. An AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, of 2.5 is recommended.

6.3.2 For palletization examination. An AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, of 6.5 is recommended.

6.4 Subject term (key word) listing.

Piton
Rock climbing
Rope

Custodian:

Army - GL

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

(Project 8465-A049)

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-C-44380(GL)	Climbers' Equipment Set, Special Operations Forces Mountaineering Equipment (SOFME)

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION

b. ADDRESS (Street, City, State, ZIP Code)

4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION (Mark one)

- ☐ VENDOR
- ☐ USER
- ☐ MANUFACTURER
- ☐ OTHER (Specify): _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER (Last, First, MI) – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER (Include Area Code) – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS (Street, City, State, ZIP Code) – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION (YYMMDD)

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NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

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